The couple was still in exile in 1627, when Jahangir died. The Moguls had a saying: When the ruler died, his sons would fight. They would either “win the throne” (become emperor) or “face the coffin” (die). The soldiers of the army were loyal to Khurram. In a short time he defeated and killed his half brothers.

On January 24, 1628, Khurram entered Agra in triumph. Mumtaz was at his side. It was a splendid parade, with the royal couple and their attendants riding elephants. They scattered coins among the crowds along the way.



Khurram became ruler on February 14. He took the name Shah Jahan. It means “King of the World.” Jewels were poured over his head. He gave Mumtaz thousands of gold pieces.